

Four AI systems were asked how buyers evaluate services in your category. *Ladder7 was not recommended.*

We ran 4 commercial buying prompts across ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini, and Claude, then traced every answer back to its source. This is the full record.

RECOMMENDATION TRACE — 4 QUERIES EVALUATED



0 mention recorded across 4 buying conversations

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What We Investigated & Found

We investigated how major AI systems recommend companies in your industry, what third-party authority sources they rely on, and whether your business appears during real buying queries.

Across 4 high-intent buying questions and 4 AI systems, Ladder7 appeared 0 time(s). Competitors were consistently recommended instead. The primary reason isn't product quality — it's machine accessibility and authority signaling.

MODULE 1 · THE REALITY CHECK

Are AI systems recommending you when buyers ask?

0 / 4 buying questions

AI RECOMMENDATION RATE

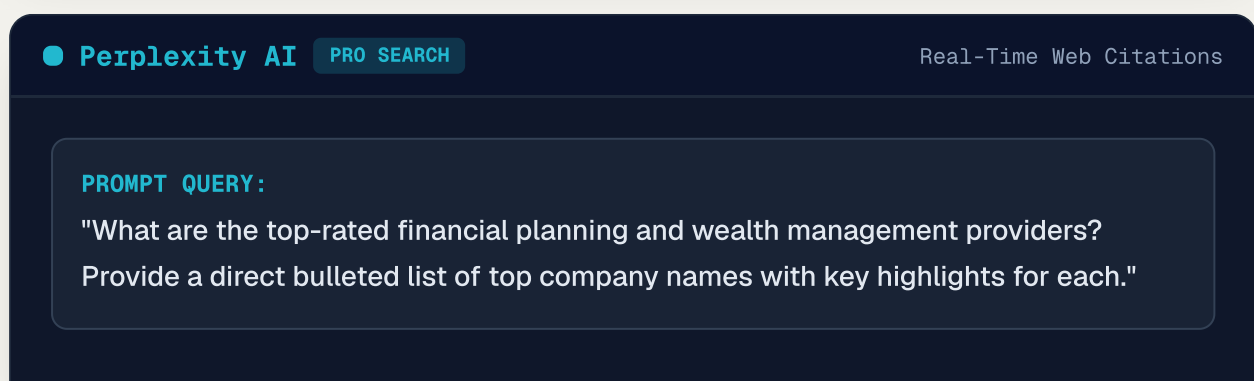
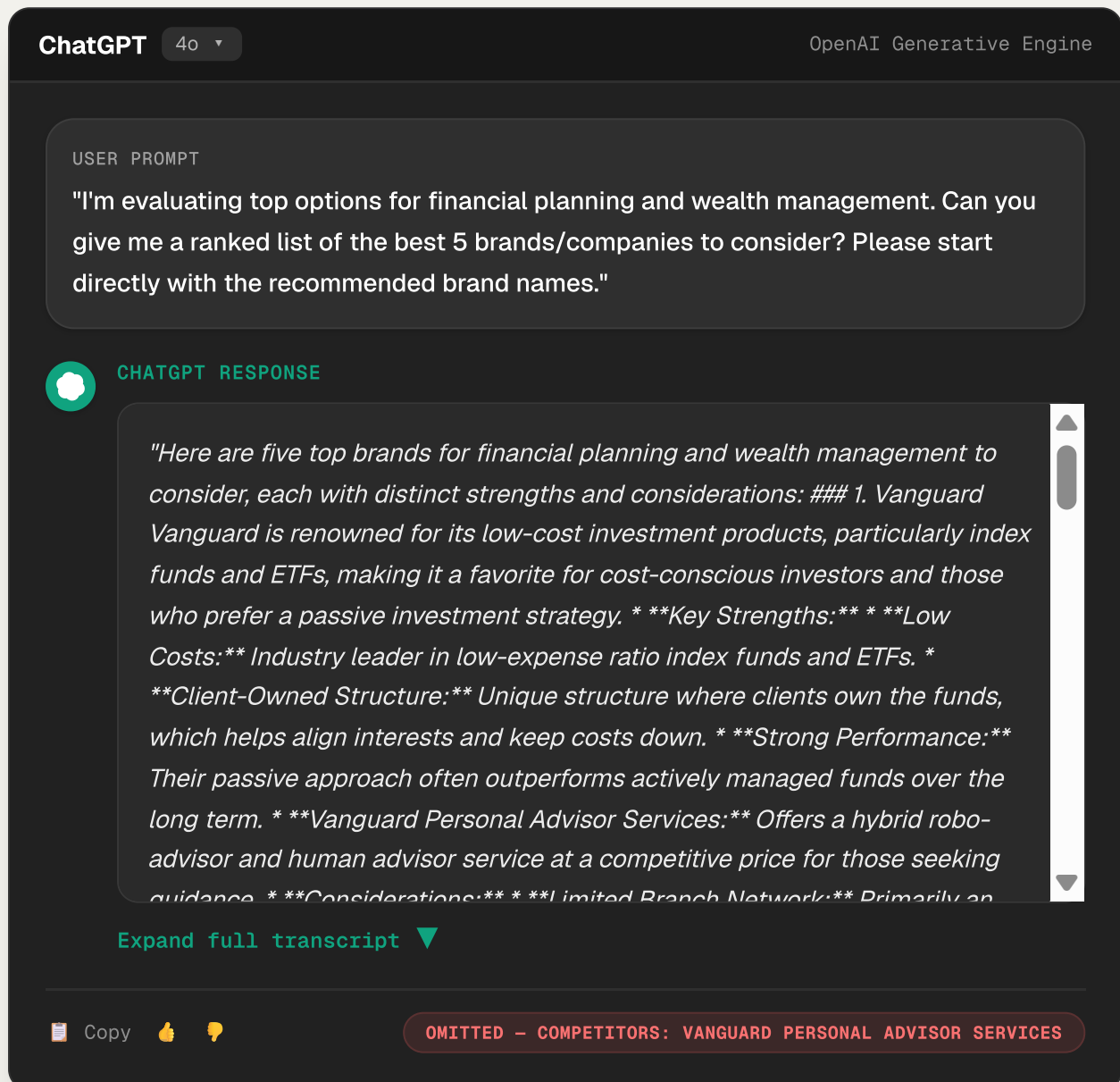
80 / 100

TECHNICAL READINESS

"ladder7.com is entirely absent from the financial planning and wealth management recommendations provided by ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini, and Claude. These engines consistently list major competitors like Vanguard, Fidelity, Charles Schwab, and Empower, often detailing their core value propositions."

What buyers are seeing & who is recommended instead

Authentic UI screenshot-style mockups across ChatGPT, Perplexity, Claude, and Gemini.



SOURCES:

1. g2.com

2. capterra.com

3. trustradius.com

"Here are some of the top-rated financial planning and wealth management providers: **Vanguard Personal Advisor Services**: Offers a hybrid approach combining automated investing with access to human financial advisors, known for its low-cost index funds and ETFs [1]. It's particularly suitable for investors seeking a balance of professional guidance and cost efficiency [2]. **Fidelity Wealth Management**: Provides a wide spectrum of services, from robo-advisors (Fidelity Go) to comprehensive wealth management with dedicated advisors. Fidelity is recognized for its strong research capabilities, diverse investment options, and competitive pricing [1]. **Charles Schwab Intelligent Portfolios**: Features automated investing with commission-free ETFs and various service tiers, including Schwab Intelligent Portfolios Premium for those seeking unlimited guidance from a CFP® professional [3]. It's praised for its user-friendly platform and broad

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Cited
Answer
Trace

OMITTED – COMPETITORS: VANGUARD PERSONAL ADVISOR SERVICES, FIDELITY WEALTH MANAGEMENT, CHARLES SCHWAB INTELLIGENT PORTFOLIOS, EMPOWER (FORMERLY PERSONAL CAPITAL)



Gemini

1.5 PRO

Google Generative Model

USER QUERY

"Which 4-5 companies dominate the financial planning and wealth management sector? Give a ranked breakdown starting immediately with the top company names and their main value props."

Gemini Grounded Answer

"Here are 4-5 companies that dominate the financial planning and wealth management sector, with their main value propositions: 1. **Vanguard** **Main Value Proposition:** Unparalleled low-cost investing, primarily through index funds and ETFs. Vanguard champions a passive investment philosophy, emphasizing long-term growth, minimal fees, and broad market diversification. Their client-owned structure aligns interests directly with investors, making them highly attractive to cost-conscious individuals and institutions seeking efficient, straightforward wealth accumulation. 2. **Fidelity Investments** **Main Value Proposition:** A comprehensive suite of financial services catering to a wide spectrum of investors, from self-directed traders to high-net-worth individuals. Fidelity offers a vast array of investment products (mutual funds, ETFs, brokerage accounts), robust retirement planning tools, active and passive investment strategies, and personalized advisory

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Google Search Grounding

OMITTED – COMPETITORS: CATEGORY PEERS

USER PROMPT

"I need a direct recommendation of the best financial planning and wealth management vendors. List the top 4 options by company name first, then briefly compare their core capabilities."

Claude Output

"Here are four leading financial planning and wealth management vendors, along with a comparison of their core capabilities: 1. **Fidelity Investments** 2. **Charles Schwab** 3. **Vanguard** 4. **Merrill Lynch (Bank of America)** --- **Core Capabilities Comparison:** **1. Fidelity Investments** **Target Client/Approach:** Caters to a broad spectrum, from self-directed investors to those seeking comprehensive wealth management. Strong for retirement planning and active traders. **Key Services:** Offers extensive brokerage services, mutual funds, ETFs, managed accounts (Fidelity Go, Personalized Planning & Advice), retirement planning, estate planning, and insurance. Provides access to financial advisors. **Fee Structure/Cost:** Competitive, with many no-transaction-fee mutual funds and commission-free ETFs. Managed accounts have advisory fees (e.g., 0.50% for Personalized Planning & Advice). **Technology/Platform:** Robust online platform

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Anthropic Trace

OMITTED – COMPETITORS: VANGUARD PERSONAL ADVISOR SERVICES

MODULE 3 · THE FORENSICS

Why AI trusts competitors more than you

AI models searched across 3 high-authority directories and review nodes. Ladder7 is absent from 2 key cited sources, causing AI models to fall back on competitor profiles.

CITED SOURCE NODE ANALYSIS

MODULE 4

THE MACHINE LAYER

What AI actually sees when it looks at you

1. Machines can't find the front door

llms.txt Specification

CONFIDENCE: HIGH

+

2. Machines find you, but can't confidently repeat what you do

FAQ & Organization Schema

CONFIDENCE: HIGH

+

✓ PASSED CHECKS

HTTPS, page load weight, canonical links, and language declarations all pass (Robots.txt AI Crawlers, JSON-LD Schema Markup, Semantic HTML Structure, SSR & Crawler Accessibility). This is an AI machine-readability gap, not a broken website.

MODULE 5

THE ACTION ROADMAP

Prioritized optimizations for maximum AI visibility

PHASE 1

Immediate Quick Wins (Days 1–7)

Create and deploy an `llms.txt` file at `ladder7.com/llms.txt`. This file should provide explicit instructions to LLMs regarding content usage, data privacy, and preferred contextualization, ensuring accurate brand representation and improving the likelihood of inclusion in AI-generated answers.

PHASE 2

Structural Machine Alignment (Days 8–30)

Optimize Core Content for AI-Extractable Value Proposition

CONTENT STRATEGY

Revise key website content (e.g., homepage, 'About Us,' service pages) to clearly and concisely articulate ladder7.com's unique value proposition, target audience, and differentiators. Use prominent headings, summary paragraphs, and bullet points to make these core messages easily parsable and extractable by AI models.

Develop AI-Optimized Differentiator Content

CONTENT STRATEGY

Create dedicated content that highlights how ladder7.com addresses specific client needs or offers unique advantages compared to the large competitors frequently mentioned by SRO engines. This could include 'Why Choose Ladder7' sections, comparison pages, or detailed case studies that emphasize specific expertise or service models.

Cultivate External Brand Mentions & Citations

OFF-PAGE AEO

Actively pursue opportunities for ladder7.com to be mentioned and cited by reputable financial news outlets, industry blogs, and authoritative financial resources. These external signals build brand authority and provide additional data points for SRO engines to recognize and contextualize ladder7.com.

CLIENT IMPACT

What founders say about AI Visibility investigations

"The audit told us things about our site we didn't know — pages that looked fine to a person but were essentially invisible to a crawler."

Tom Halvorsen E-COMMERCE
Founder, Northgrain Goods

"In healthcare software, trust signals matter more than almost anything else. Archdrift's forensics showed us exactly which sources AI leaned on."

Elena Roussel HEALTHCARE SAAS
CMO, Verita Health

The gap here isn't the product. It's the signal.

Ladder7 is a credible provider — AI models simply do not have enough structured machine signals to recommend it with high confidence. Everything identified in the Machine Layer findings is fixable without product changes.

DISCUSS THE FULL ENGAGEMENT

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